MIL-T-44208
AMENDMENT-1
24 November 1987

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TUNA WITH NOODLES, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-T-44208, dated 15 January 1986, and is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 3

2.2: Add the following:

"AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)"

PAGE 4

3.2.4 Delete and substitute:

"3.2.4 Cheese, cream, dehydrated. The dehydrated cream cheese shall be derived from fresh cream cheese complying with the Standards of Identity for Cream Cheese. The dehydrated cheese shall be white to light in color, uniform in appearance and composition, and possess a characteristic pleasing and desirable flavor. The product shall be free-flowing, free from lumps that do not fall apart under light finger pressure and be free from specks and burnt particles. The dehydrated cheese shall contain not more than 3.0 percent moisture and not less than 70 percent milkfat."

PAGE 5

3.2.9, line 5: Delete "4.5" and substitute "5.5".

PAGE 6

3.2.15: Delete in entirety.

3.3.2, lines 2 and 3: Delete "and the drained brine shall be retained for inclusion in the sauce (see 3.3.4)".



DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 6 (cont'd)

3.3.3 b., line 1: Delete "for 3 minutes" and substitute "to approximately double in weight".

PAGE 7

3.3.4, line 4: Delete "and mushroom brine 77.628" and under "percent by weight" substitute "79.880".
Line 5: After "cheese" add ", dehydrated". Delete "4.500 and substitute "2.250".
Line 16: Delete "Annatto powder 0.002".

3.3.4 a., line 2: Delete "and mushroom brine".

PAGE 8

3.4 b., line 2: Delete "1 hour" and substitute "2 hours".

3.6 f.: Delete and substitute:

"f. The average drained weight of tuna, noodles, and vegetables (combined) shall be not less than 5.5 ounces."

3.6 g.: Delete and substitute:

"g. No individual pouch shall contain less than 4.5 ounces of drained, tuna, noodles and vegetables (combined)."

3.6 h.: Delete in entirety.

3.6 i.: Delete in entirety.

PAGE 9

3.6 n.: Delete in entirety.

3.6 q.: Delete "3.0" and substitute "3.8".

PAGE 10

4.5.1.1: Delete and substitute:

"4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product."

PAGE 11

4.5.5 and table I: Delete in entirety and substitute the following new paragraphs and tables:

"4.5.5 Product and drained weight inspection.

4.5.5.1 Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180° to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The contents shall be inspected for the defects indicated in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

| Lot size (pouches) | Sample size (pouches) | Cumulative sample | Acceptance number | Rejection number |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 to 500,000 | 20 | -- | 0 | 2 |
| | 20 | 40 | 1 | 2 |

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Tuna, noodles, and vegetables not uniformly distributed. |
| 102 | Texture of tuna is dry, rubbery, or mushy. |
| 103 | Texture of noodles is mushy or tough. |
| 104 | Texture of mushrooms is mushy or tough. |
| 105 | Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched). |

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

4.5.5.2 Drained weight inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The drained weight shall be determined and inspected for the defect listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for drained weight inspection 1/ 2/

| Lot size (pouches) | Sample size (pouches) | Cumulative sample | Acceptance number | Rejection number |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 to 500,000 | 20 | -- | 0 | 2 |
| | 20 | 40 | 1 | 2 |

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180° to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated such as to separate sauce from tuna, noodles and vegetables. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 7 (0.111 inch) sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45 degree angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

TABLE IV. Drained weight defect

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Drained weight of tuna, noodles, and vegetables (combined) in a pouch is less than 4.5 ounces. 1/ |

1/ The lot shall be rejected if the sample average drained weight of tuna, noodles, and vegetables (combined) is less than 5.5 ounces."

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0627

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T00:36Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.